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**Gov. Braun Awards Grant to Transform Rural Healthcare
in West-Central Indiana Region**

Indianapolis, IN- Gov. Mike Braun announced today that the west-central Indiana region (Region 3) has been awarded \$9.7 million in Growing Rural Opportunities for Well-being (GROW) initiative grants. GROW region three includes Benton, Boone, Carroll, Clinton, Fountain, Montgomery, Warren and White counties.

GROW is focused on improving healthcare access, quality and outcomes in rural communities across the state of Indiana and supported by the Indiana Rural Health Transformation Program (RHTP), administered by the Indiana Department of Health (IDOH) and Family and Social Services Administration (FSSA). Indiana received nearly \$207 million for the first year of the five-year federal Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) grant program. About \$120 million, or 60% of that funding, was earmarked for the regional grants.

"The Trump Administration's Rural Health Transformation Program is based on one simple idea: your access to quality health care shouldn't depend on your ZIP code," said CMS Administrator Dr. Mehmet Oz. "Funding new approaches to expand access and improve health outcomes for rural Hoosiers is an important step toward achieving that vision and I look forward to seeing RHTP dollars support equally transformative innovations for rural communities nationwide."

"This funding is a major step forward in our commitment to making health care affordable and accessible for all Hoosiers," Gov. Braun said. "It's an important stride toward creating a more sustainable and connected network in rural Indiana."

Region 3 GROW grant activities include:

- **Expand Mobile Integrated Health:** Bring care into residents' homes through chronic disease monitoring, medication management, 24–72-hour post-discharge follow-up, behavioral health crisis response, prenatal home visits and telehealth support.

- **Leverage Transportation and Navigation:** Expand access to medical appointments, pharmacies and essential services for rural residents.
- **Provide New Access Points:** Expand clinic capacity, add primary care and behavioral health access points, launch mobile medical and dental services and support medication delivery for high-risk rural residents.
- **Improve Rural Prenatal Care Access:** Boost regional prenatal referrals and care coordination, expand telehealth and remote patient monitoring, deploy trusted activators to conduct outreach, mobile services, postnatal support and education and distribution of prevention and support resources.
- **Support Chronic Disease Prevention:** Train community health workers, implement screening and referral workflows in clinical settings, conduct patient outreach and education focused on prevention and management of chronic conditions.

Rural Health Transformation Program's GROW will now move into implementation building on a foundation of strong collaboration, local leadership and meaningful impact from targeted activities.

Region 3's award complements the seven other regions that received GROW regional grants. RHTP also includes 11 statewide initiatives that promote workforce investment, thoughtful partnerships and infrastructure development. Additional information about the GROW regional grants and 11 statewide initiatives are available on the RHTP website growruralhealth.in.gov.

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